

The agentic loop

What happens between your message and the answer, however many passes that takes.

COMPONENT

PROCESS

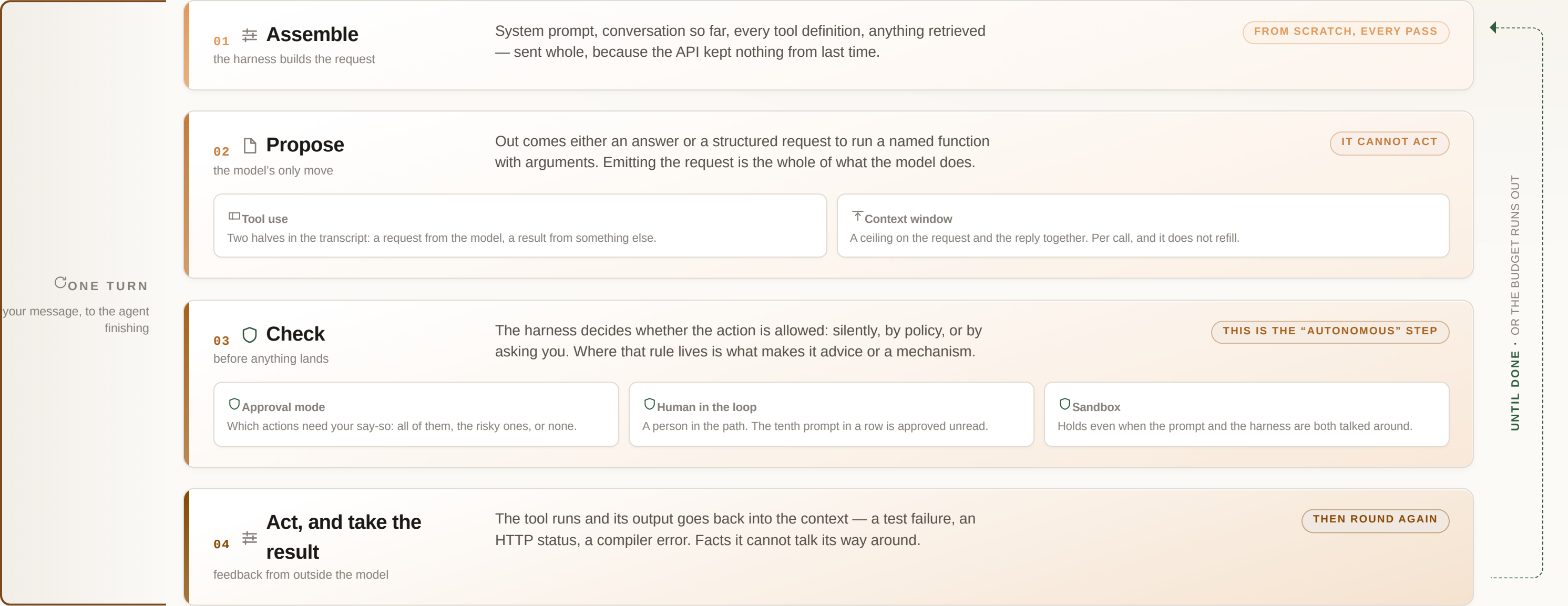
TECHNIQUE

CONTROL

CEILING

ARTIFACT

STORE



WHAT DECIDES HOW FAR IT GOES

CONTROL

Autonomy level — Set per action class, not per product: free on reads, gated on writes, forbidden on a short list.

WHEN THE RUN GETS LONG

TECHNIQUE

Compaction — Older turns swapped for a summary so the run keeps fitting. Lossy on purpose — the original wording is gone.

WHAT OUTLIVES IT

STORE

Long-term memory — A session ends and takes its window with it. What survives is files the harness writes and reads back — not a faculty of the model.

The loop is the product. A model call answers once; everything you recognise as an agent is this cycle, plus the rules about when it may act.